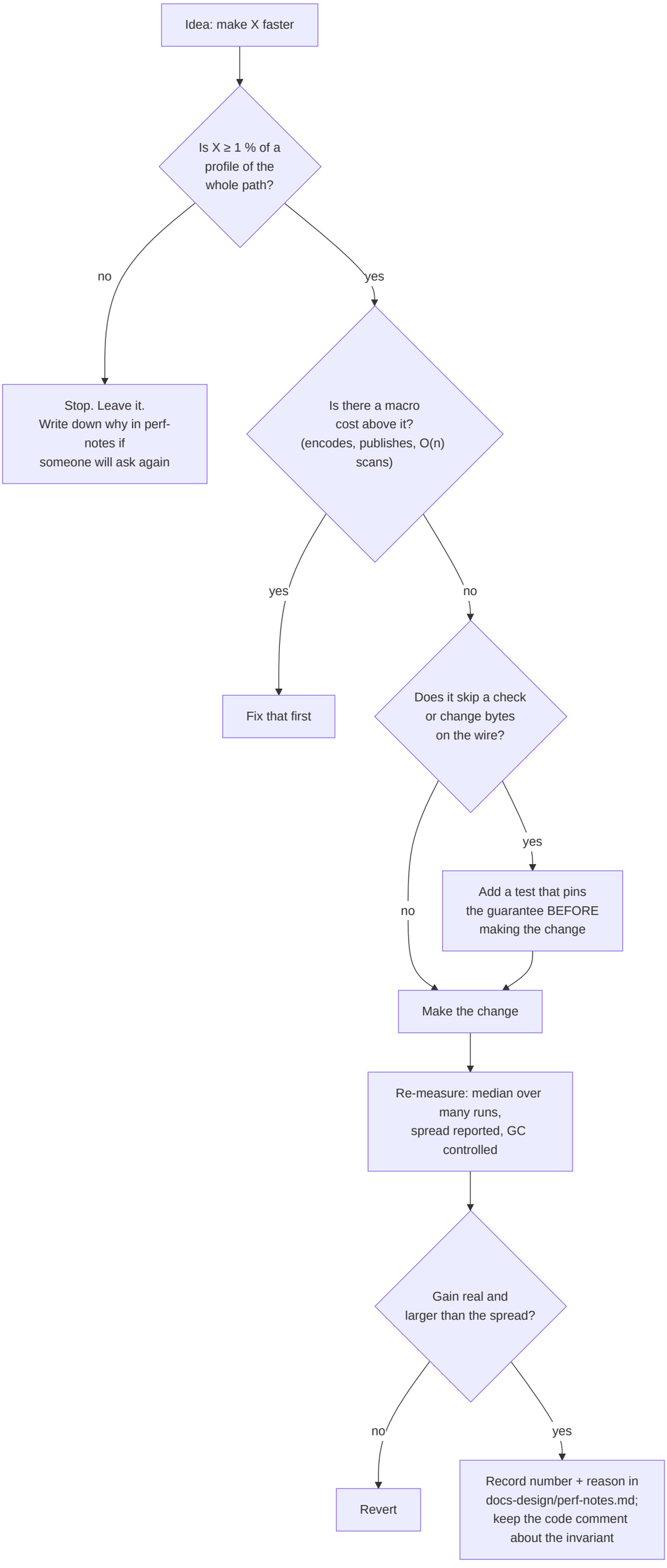
Idea: make X faster
Is X ≥ 1 % of a profile of the whole path?
no
yes
Stop. Leave it. Write down why in perf-notes if someone will ask again
Is there a macro cost above it? (encodes, publishes, O(n) scans)
yes
no
Fix that first
Does it skip a check or change bytes on the wire?
yes
no
Add a test that pins the guarantee BEFORE making the change
Make the change
Re-measure: median over many runs, spread reported, GC controlled
Gain real and larger than the spread?
no
yes
Revert
Record number + reason in docs-design/perf-notes.md; keep the code comment about the invariant